

PROJECT CLOSE-OUT REPORT

AHI Marketing Analytics App Development Project

Project Name:	AHI Marketing Analytics App Development Project	Report Date:	December 1, 20XX
Division / Department:	Marketing	Project End Date:	November 30, 20XX
Project Sponsor:	Mary Smithers	Project Manager:	Cary Manning

PROJECT GOALS

Original Goals from Project Charter
1. Design, develop, and launch a marketing analytics app enabling real-time data collection, analysis, and reporting for both internal (AHI) and external (customer) users.
2. Deliver internal capabilities including: market trend tracking, competitive analysis, market share calculation by product category, and customer interest/preference monitoring.
3. Enable external customer capabilities including: easy product access and browsing, secure invoicing, reliable order processing, and transaction confirmation.
4. Replace disconnected marketing analytics systems with a unified real-time platform to enable better business decision-making.
5. Complete all five project phases (Design, Development, Test, Launch, Improve) within budget (\$250,000) and schedule (April–November 20XX).

PROJECT GOAL SUCCESS ANALYSIS

Goal	Outcome	Notes / Explanation
1. Design, develop, and launch marketing analytics app for internal and external users	SUCCESS	All five user stories implemented and accepted. App launched October 22, 20XX.
2. Deliver all internal analytics capabilities (trend tracking, competitive analysis, market share, preference monitoring)	SUCCESS	All internal features delivered per product backlog and accepted by stakeholders.
3. Enable external customer capabilities (product access, secure invoicing, order processing, confirmation)	SUCCESS	External user features validated by customer focus group. Secure transactions tested and PCI-DSS compliant.
4. Replace disconnected marketing systems with unified real-time platform	PARTIAL SUCCESS	Platform integrated with 4 of 5 target data feeds. One legacy system integration deferred to Version 2 due to API incompatibility discovered in test phase.

5. Complete all phases within budget (\$250,000) and schedule (Apr–Nov 20XX)	PARTIAL SUCCESS	Schedule: 1-week delay in Launch phase recovered; project closed on time by Nov 30. Budget: \$7,000 overrun (\$257,000 actual vs \$250,000 baseline); approved by sponsor from contingency.
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SCOPE REVIEW

One scope variance occurred: integration with one legacy marketing data system was deferred to Version 2. During the Test phase, an API incompatibility was discovered that would have required an additional 3–4 weeks and approximately \$12,000 in unbudgeted development time. The CCB approved deferral as the remaining four data feeds met minimum requirements for launch.

Prevention in Future Projects: Conduct API compatibility assessment during the Design phase before vendor contract finalization. Include a formal data integration feasibility study as a required Design phase deliverable.

SCHEDULE REVIEW

The project experienced a 1-week schedule delay during the Launch phase (October 15 target vs. October 22 actual launch). Root causes: (1) IT infrastructure rework required after load testing revealed configuration needed adjustment for revised user volumes; (2) IT hiring process took 2 additional days beyond plan.

Recovery: Cary Manning implemented a compressed testing schedule and the team worked extended hours during October 16–21. The project closed on schedule by November 30, 20XX.

Prevention in Future Projects: Establish IT infrastructure specifications with confirmed user load requirements during Design phase. Do not allow infrastructure provisioning to begin before stakeholder confirmation of scale requirements. Begin IT hiring process in Test phase (not Launch phase).

COST REVIEW

Cost Category	Budgeted	Actual	Variance
App Development	\$180,000	\$180,000	\$0
IT Software and Hardware	\$15,000	\$15,000	\$0
IT Storage	\$15,000	\$15,000	\$0
Data Feeds	\$5,000	\$5,000	\$0
App Security Upgrades	\$20,000	\$27,000	+\$7,000 (OVER)
IT Personnel (HR)	\$15,000	\$15,000	\$0
TOTAL	\$250,000	\$257,000	+\$7,000 (OVER)

Cost Variance Note: \$7,000 overrun in App Security Upgrades resulted from additional security hardening required after independent security audit found two medium-severity vulnerabilities during Test phase. Sponsor approved drawdown from contingency reserve. Prevention: Include security architecture review earlier in the Design phase.

RISK ANALYSIS

The following risks from the Risk Register materialized during the project:

RISK R-4 (Resource Risk – IT Hiring): The IT hiring delay risk materialized. New hires were not onboarded until October 25 (3 days after launch). An IT contractor was engaged for bridge support October 22–25 at a cost of \$1,500 (absorbed within contingency).

RISK R-6 (Security Risk): App security vulnerabilities were identified during the Test phase. Two medium-severity issues required remediation and added \$7,000 to the budget. This was the primary driver of the cost overrun.

OPPORTUNITIES: The external vendor brought enhanced sentiment analysis capabilities that were incorporated into the marketing analytics dashboard at no additional cost, exceeding original scope in a positive way.

Future Prevention: Implement mandatory security architecture review in Design phase. Add security testing as a formal milestone in the Test phase. Begin IT hiring during the Development phase for projects of similar scale.

OUTSTANDING ITEMS

Issue / Outstanding Item	Planned Resolution	Assigned To
Legacy Data System Integration: One legacy marketing data feed not integrated in v1 due to API incompatibility.	Deferred to Version 2. API requirements to be addressed in Version 2 Design phase. Target completion: Q1 Next Year.	Priya Service / Cal Hamer
Version 2 Feature Backlog: Enhanced reporting features and additional market analytics capabilities identified during project have been documented in the product backlog for Version 2 planning.	Cal Hamer to convene Version 2 planning session in December. Version 2 project charter to be submitted to Mary Smithers by January 15, Next Year.	Cal Hamer / Ram Samuels
Post-Launch App Performance Monitoring: Ongoing monitoring of app performance, user adoption rates, and customer satisfaction scores for 90-day post-launch period.	Monthly performance reports to be issued through February. Monitoring transitioned to IT Operations team under Priya Service.	Priya Service

LESSONS LEARNED

DID WELL	
Change Control	The CCB, established at Mary Smithers' direction, functioned effectively and prevented uncontrolled scope creep. All change requests were formally evaluated, and three were deferred to Version 2, protecting the project baseline.
Stakeholder Communication	Weekly sponsor meetings and structured status reports kept all key stakeholders informed and enabled timely decisions. Mary Smithers praised the quality and consistency of communication throughout the project.
Quality Assurance	Keiko Tanaka's QA leadership and the structured beta testing process resulted in a high-quality app at launch. Customer acceptance criteria were met on the first formal review.
DO BETTER	

IT Infrastructure Planning	IT infrastructure was over-provisioned in Sprint 1 (built for 20M users vs actual 4M required). Stakeholder confirmation of scale requirements must be obtained and documented before IT provisioning begins.
Scrum Mastery	Cary Manning, while an excellent predictive PM, had no Scrum experience. Future Scrum projects should include a certified Scrum Master. Sprint planning suffered from a lack of agile expertise.
Security Planning	Security review should be embedded in the Design phase, not discovered in Test. Two vulnerabilities required emergency remediation, causing cost overrun and schedule pressure.

RECOMMENDATIONS

1. For future technology development projects: Assign a dedicated Scrum Master with certified agile experience when using Scrum methodology. Do not assign a predictive PM without Scrum training as Scrum Master.
2. Conduct mandatory API and data integration compatibility assessments during the Design phase for any project involving data feed or system integration.
3. Include a formal security architecture review with external security consultant as a required milestone before Development phase begins.
4. Confirm infrastructure scale requirements (user volumes, data loads) with all relevant stakeholders before IT provisioning. Document confirmed requirements with formal sign-off.
5. Begin recruiting for all new-hire positions at least 60 days before the positions are needed on the project.

PROJECT ARCHIVES

All project documents, including the Project Charter, WBS, Risk Register, Product Backlog, Sprint Backlogs, Status Reports, Quality Management Plan, Communications Management Plan, and this Close-Out Report, are archived in the AHI Project Management SharePoint site under: Marketing > Projects > AHI App Development > [Project Year]. Access managed by Priya Service (IT). Contact the PMO (Cal Hamer) for access requests.

Lessons Learned Session Conducted:	November 20, 20XX (Cary Manning, facilitated by Keiko Tanaka)
Closeout Review Complete:	December 1, 20XX – Approved by Mary Smithers, Project Sponsor

Prepared by: Cary Manning, Project Manager | Approved by: Mary Smithers, Project Sponsor | December 1, 20XX